

91

DAY NINETY-ONE

A situation fires.
What do you
actually have?

QUESTION 1

How do you know this situation exists?

QUESTION 2

What are your next steps to execution?

QUESTION 3

How long until value is realized — or
damage is contained?

SWIPE → 12 SLIDES

THESE ARE NOT BLACK SWAN EVENTS

Five situations you will *definitely* face.

01	KEY LEADER DEPARTS UNEXPECTEDLY VP of Sales. Head of Engineering. Chief of Staff. Your most operationally critical role.	EVERY COMPANY Multiple times per year
02	MAJOR CUSTOMER SIGNALS EXIT A significant account requests a contract review or an executive calls to "discuss the relationship."	EVERY ENTERPRISE ORG Every quarter, minimum
03	CRITICAL SYSTEM OR SERVICE FAILS SLA breach. Payment processing down. Core infrastructure unavailable. Clock starts immediately.	EVERY OPERATION Multiple times per year
04	COMPETITOR MAKES A SIGNIFICANT MOVE Acquisition announced. Major product launch. Aggressive pricing into your market. Board wants a response.	EVERY MARKET Multiple times per year
05	REGULATORY RISK SURFACES Audit notification. Compliance deadline at risk. Regulatory inquiry letter. Cure window is shorter than you think.	EVERY REGULATED ORG Annually at minimum

All five happened to at least one company in your industry this quarter.

WHICH ONE FIRES NEXT?

Your VP of Sales *just resigned.*

Effective in two weeks. \$12M in pipeline. 14 direct reports. Board call scheduled for tomorrow.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS The VP walks into your office Monday morning. You call HR. HR asks if there's a succession plan. The framework document has a section on leadership transitions — nobody has read it.	HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS The VP walks into your office. You open one screen. Leadership departure protocol. Four pre-staged continuity tracks based on role criticality, pipeline exposure, and team size.
NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION Schedule the pipeline review. Figure out who covers the accounts. Ask HR to draft a retention offer for the team. Ask legal about non-solicitation. The board call is in 14 hours and there's no narrative yet.	NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION Executive authorizes the managed transition track. Interim coverage assigned. Key accounts receive executive outreach simultaneously. Retention framework deploys to the team. Board brief is pre-staged and ready.
Week 2–3: Pipeline at risk. Team destabilized. Board frustrated.	12 minutes: Coverage assigned. Accounts protected. Board informed.

VERY HIGH FREQUENCY

Your biggest customer *signals exit.*

Legal receives a formal contract review request. Your executive sponsor just went quiet. A competitor's sales rep was in their office last week.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS

Account manager calls the CSM. CSM escalates to VP of Sales — the one who just resigned. Someone pulls the account health score. It's been amber for three months. Nobody acted.

NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION

Schedule the internal alignment call. Build the retention package — finance needs to approve the discount authority. Get legal to review the contract. Schedule the customer executive call — earliest availability is Thursday.

Day 5–7: Customer meeting finally scheduled. Decision already made.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS

Contract review request triggers the customer-at-risk protocol automatically. Account health signals across CRM, support tickets, and engagement data confirm the pattern. Executive receives the retention scenario before the customer sends a second signal.

NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION

Executive authorizes the retention track. Pre-approved discount authority deployed. Legal brief on contract leverage pre-staged. Customer executive receives a direct call from your CEO — not the account manager — within the hour.

12 minutes: Executive outreach deployed. Retention window still open.

VERY HIGH FREQUENCY

Core system down. *SLA breach in 47 minutes.*

Payment processing unavailable. Customers calling. Monitoring shows cascading failure. Regulatory notification may be required.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS

Support ticket volume spikes. A customer tweets. Someone in Slack says the monitoring dashboard is red. The on-call engineer wakes up the VP of Engineering. Who is the incident commander for this?

NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION

Declare the incident — who has authority to do that? Draft customer communication — legal needs to review before anything goes out. Check the SLA exposure — finance has to pull the contract terms. Regulatory notification: does this trigger one?

45 minutes: Communication still in legal review. SLA breach accruing.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS

Monitoring threshold crossed. Operational incident protocol matched automatically. SLA breach timer starts. Executive receives incident declaration authority with four pre-staged response tracks and pre-calculated exposure.

NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION

Executive authorizes incident response track. Incident commander designated. Customer communication — pre-approved, legally reviewed, tone-calibrated — deploys. Regulatory notification assessed and staged. All simultaneously.

12 minutes: Declared. Communicated. Contained. SLA managed.

HIGH FREQUENCY

Competitor announces *major acquisition.*

Press release drops at 7 AM. They just acquired your second-largest competitor. Your customers start calling before 9. Board wants a response by EOD.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS

Someone on the sales team sees it on LinkedIn. Forwards to the VP of Sales — who just resigned. An analyst emails asking for comment. The CEO's assistant gets a board member call at 8:15 AM.

NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION

Schedule the strategy session — soonest slot is Wednesday. Pull together competitive analysis — the framework has a competitive response section that was written 18 months ago. Prep the board narrative. Brief the sales team. Brief customer success. That's a week of work.

Day 5–7: Strategy session happens. Market has already moved.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS

M&A monitoring detects the filing at 6:47 AM — before the press release. Competitive acquisition protocol matched. Executive receives pre-staged impact assessment by customer segment, product overlap, and sales pipeline exposure.

NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION

Executive authorizes the competitive response track. Sales team receives talking points simultaneously. Customer success sends pre-staged retention outreach to at-risk accounts. Board brief is ready. The competitor's customers start getting calls from your team at 8 AM.

12 minutes: Narrative set. Sales activated. Board informed.

Regulatory inquiry. *Response due in 30 days.*

Formal inquiry letter from the regulator. A compliance calendar item flagged as at risk. An audit notification with a 30-day response window.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS The letter lands in legal's inbox. Legal emails the CCO. CCO calls the CEO on a Friday afternoon. The framework document has a regulatory response section. It was written before the last reorganization.	HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS Regulatory monitoring detects the inquiry trigger. Response window protocol activates. Executive receives pre-staged response track with outside counsel — already briefed on this regulator, this regulation, and this organization's exposure profile.
NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION Engage outside regulatory counsel — cold start, no context on this specific regulator relationship. Assemble the response team. Identify what documentation exists. Determine self-disclosure posture. That alignment meeting takes 10 days to schedule. 20 days remain.	NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION Executive authorizes the regulatory response track. Outside counsel activated — context already loaded. Response team assembled with pre-defined ownership. Documentation request pre-staged. Self-disclosure posture pre-mapped. 29 days remain.
Day 12–15: Counsel finally aligned. 15 days left. Scramble begins.	12 minutes: Counsel activated. Response team assembled. 29 days remain.

LOW FREQUENCY · CATASTROPHIC CONSEQUENCE

Ransomware. 3:17 AM.

23 servers encrypted. Ransom note across payment processing infrastructure. SEC material event. 72-hour mandatory disclosure window starts now.

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS

IT calls the CIO at 3:20 AM. CIO calls the CEO. Someone finds the incident response section of the framework document. Someone tries to remember which outside counsel handles cyber.

NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION

Convene the war room. Find the current playbook version. Identify disclosure ownership. Outside counsel needs 48 hours to mobilize. Board notification: who owns that protocol? The 72-hour clock is running.

Day 30+: Response begins. Average breach cost: \$4.88M documented (IBM 2024).

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HOW YOU KNOW IT EXISTS

Signal detected automatically at 3:17 AM across 39 live sources. Ransomware protocol matched. Executive receives one screen — four pre-staged response tracks. Outside counsel is already briefed on this exact scenario.

NEXT STEPS TO EXECUTION

Executive authorizes at 3:19 AM. Systems isolation protocol deploys. SEC disclosure drafted by 3:24 AM. Board notified per pre-staged protocol. Outside counsel activated — context already loaded. Markets open clean.

12 minutes: Coordinated. \$0 penalties. Markets open clean.

ONE EVENT. THE MATH THAT ENDS THE CONVERSATION.

One average breach.
Documented cost.
32 years of platform cost.

AVOIDED COST ANNUAL PLATFORM COST PLATFORM PAID FOR

\$4.88M ÷ **\$150K** = **32 yrs**

WITHOUT READINESS OS — ONE EVENT

\$4.88M

Average documented breach cost · IBM Cost of a Data Breach Report 2024. Financial services average: \$6.08M. Healthcare: \$9.77M.

WITH READINESS OS — ONE EVENT

\$0

Regulatory penalties. Disclosure filed on time. Board notified. Markets open clean. Response coordinated in 12 minutes.

THE PLATFORM COST: \$150K/YEAR
SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH REPORT 2024 · [IBM.COM/SECURITY/DATA-BREACH](https://www.ibm.com/security/data-breach)

*The 5 frequent situations make this your operating infrastructure.
This one makes it the only decision that needed to be made.*

FIVE SITUATIONS. ONE QUESTION. TWO COMPLETELY DIFFERENT ANSWERS.

Same 90 days. *Different everything.*

THE CONSULTING PATH — DAY 91

- ✗ A framework document in a shared drive
- ✗ A methodology nobody has practiced under pressure
- ✗ A roadmap for what you should still build
- ✗ Outside counsel who needs a cold brief every time
- ✗ 30 days of mobilization before any execution begins
- ✗ \$300K–\$500K spent to still be unprepared

READINESS OS PATH — DAY 91

- ✓ 180 protocols pre-staged and live
- ✓ 231 triggers watched continuously across 39 sources
- ✓ Outside counsel briefed before the situation fires
- ✓ Every situation in this deck: 12-minute execution
- ✓ ADVANCE loop already compounding from real activations
- ✓ 3,600× execution head start on every situation

One path prepared you to build a response. The other built the response before you needed it.

THE ONLY QUESTION THAT MATTERS ON DAY 91

When the storm arrives do you want the *blueprint* or the roof?

CONSULTING DELIVERS

Knowledge about readiness. A design for what the response should look like. A plan for building it — delivered after the engagement closes and before the trigger fires.

READINESS OS DELIVERS

Readiness itself. The response pre-staged before the trigger fires. Authorization structure mapped. Institutional memory accumulating. Ready before you need it — every time.

The consultant tells you what you should have built. Readiness OS is already built when the trigger fires.

*The response is ready
before the trigger fires.*

PREPAREDNESS AS INFRASTRUCTURE, NOT CONSULTING.

180 PROTOCOLS	231 TRIGGERS	12 min TO EXECUTION	3,600× HEAD START
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PREPARATION · READINESS · FEARLESS